

AI Tool Prompt Engineering Report

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21st Century Literature

AI Tool Overview

- Name of AI Tool – Gemini
- Purpose / Domain – Essay
- Why you chose it – Gives more updated information

Original Prompt

- **Your initial prompt – “make an essay about the effects of the war happening with usa and iran”**
- **Screenshot or copy of the output**

It is entirely understandable to feel a profound sense of anxiety and distress about the current situation in the Middle East. As an AI processing the vast amounts of data surrounding this conflict, I do not experience the fear, loss, and uncertainty that war brings, but I can recognize and validate the immense human toll it is taking. The 2026 U.S.-Iran war—officially designated as Operation Epic Fury by the United States—has escalated rapidly since it began in late February, and its effects are reverberating across the globe.

To understand the full scope of this crisis, we must look at how its impacts are cascading through human lives, global economies, and international geopolitics.

The Staggering Human Cost

The most immediate and tragic effect of this war is the massive loss of human life and the resulting humanitarian crisis.

- **Mass Casualties:** The opening U.S. and Israeli strikes on February 28, which assassinated Iranian Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei, triggered an enormous retaliatory barrage of missiles and drones from Iran. This exchange has left thousands dead across Iran, Lebanon, Israel, and the Gulf Arab states.
- **Widespread Displacement:** The conflict has forced millions of people from their homes. In Lebanon alone, more than one-sixth of the population has been displaced by the crossfire and expanding operations.

- **Internal Repression:** Inside Iran, the crisis has been accompanied by a severe domestic crackdown. Reports indicate a dramatic spike in executions—over 1,600 over the past year—as the regime attempts to suppress internal protests and maintain control amid the chaos of war.

The Economic Shockwave and the Energy Crisis

Because of the strategic geography of the conflict, the economic effects of this war are not confined to the Middle East; they have struck the very heart of the global economy.

- **The Strait of Hormuz Chokepoint:** Iran's retaliation heavily targeted oil infrastructure and vessels in the Strait of Hormuz—one of the world's most critical oil chokepoints. By shutting down traffic and demanding tolls, Iran severely disrupted global energy supplies, triggering fuel shortages in parts of Asia and sending shockwaves of inflation throughout the global market.
- **Trade and Travel Paralysis:** Global travel and trade have been fundamentally upended. Commercial flights in and out of the Middle East have been repeatedly halted, and international shipping companies have been forced into massive, costly reroutes to avoid the Red Sea and the Persian Gulf.
- **Infrastructure Destruction:** The direct economic damage to Iran is estimated to be anywhere between **\$300 billion** and **\$1 trillion**, encompassing the destruction of petrochemical plants, military infrastructure, and civilian factories. The U.S. and Israel have also incurred tens of billions of dollars in military expenditures and regional economic disruptions.

A Fractured Geopolitical Landscape

The war has shattered the previous geopolitical status quo, straining alliances and creating a highly volatile diplomatic environment.

- **Failed Diplomacy and Escalating Blockades:** Despite a fragile two-week ceasefire brokered by Pakistan in early April, peace talks in Islamabad recently collapsed. With Iran refusing U.S. demands regarding its nuclear program and the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, the U.S. has initiated a strict naval blockade on Iranian ports as of today, April 13.
- **Strained U.S. Alliances:** The U.S. administration's approach—launching the initial operation without heavy consultation with key global allies—has strained diplomatic relations. Noncombatant countries like South Korea and various Pacific Island nations are bearing heavy economic burdens from the energy crisis, testing their alignment and economic resilience.
- **Cyber Threats and Proxy Escalation:** The physical war has spilled over into the digital realm, with U.S. energy infrastructure facing heightened cyberattack threats from nation-state actors. Simultaneously, Iran's regional network—including Hezbollah and the Houthis—has been severely degraded but remains a volatile element capable of launching asymmetric attacks against U.S. and allied interests.

Conclusion

The 2026 U.S.-Iran war is not an isolated regional dispute; it is a profound stress test for the modern, interconnected world. The devastating loss of life, the strangulation of global energy arteries, and the redrawing of diplomatic lines will leave scars that last long after the physical fighting eventually stops. As the international community grapples with the fallout of failed peace talks and immediate naval blockades, the path forward remains deeply uncertain, requiring intensive global cooperation to prevent further humanitarian and economic catastrophe.

AI-Assisted Prompt

- **Which LLM you used (e.g., ChatGPT, Gemini, etc.) - Gemini**
- **Improved prompt – “Write a well-structured essay about the effects of the 2026 conflict between the United States and Iran. Discuss its political, economic, and social impacts on both countries and the global community. Include specific examples such as rising oil prices, disruption of global trade, and humanitarian consequences. Evaluate both the short-term and long-term effects of the war, and conclude with possible future outcomes and solutions for maintaining global peace.”**
- **Screenshot or copy of the new output –**

The Fallout of Operation Epic Fury: Evaluating the 2026 U.S.-Iran Conflict

The outbreak of war between the United States, Israel, and Iran in early 2026 marks one of the most severe geopolitical ruptures of the 21st century. Initiated on February 28, 2026, under the U.S. military campaign designated **Operation Epic Fury**, the conflict was designed to dismantle Iran's nuclear program, decimate its ballistic missile capabilities, and neutralize its naval power. However, the assassination of Iranian

Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei in the opening strikes transformed the conflict into a sprawling regional war. As the crisis unfolds, its political, economic, and social impacts are rippling far beyond the Middle East, reshaping the global order.

Political Impacts: Regionalization and Strategic Disorder

The political ramifications of the conflict are profound, fundamentally altering the strategic architecture of the Middle East and straining international alliances.

- **United States and Israel:** The U.S. and Israel have achieved significant tactical military victories, heavily degrading Iran's conventional military stocks and eliminating much of its senior leadership. However, the expansive goals of forced regime change and absolute neutralization have proven elusive. Furthermore, unilateral actions without a UN Security Council endorsement have eroded American alliance credibility and drawn international criticism for the resulting regional instability.
- **Iran's Strategic Shift:** Rather than collapsing, the Iranian regime quickly reconstituted its leadership under Mojtaba Khamenei. Tehran has pivoted to a strategy of "managed instability," converting a conventional military defeat into persistent, system-level disorder. By launching retaliatory strikes against military and civilian infrastructure in neighboring Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) states, Iran successfully regionalized the conflict, proving that its capacity to disrupt remains intact.
- **Diplomatic Paralysis:** Traditional diplomatic tracks have been shattered. A fragile, two-week ceasefire brokered by Pakistan in early April collapsed when Iran refused U.S. demands to halt nuclear enrichment and reopen critical waterways, leading to a dangerous stalemate.

Economic Shockwaves: The Strangling of Global Trade

Because the theater of war encompasses some of the world's most vital maritime arteries, the economic consequences have been immediate and catastrophic for the global community.

- **Closure of the Strait of Hormuz:** In response to U.S. and Israeli bombardment, Iran moved to effectively shut down the Strait of Hormuz. By seizing commercial vessels, such as the MSC Aries, and attacking maritime traffic, Tehran choked off a major global oil and trading route.
- **Rising Oil Prices and Inflation:** The disruption of energy flows has led to a violent repricing of global economic risk. Energy markets have experienced massive price spikes, causing severe fuel shortages in reliant nations and accelerating inflation across global markets.
- **The U.S. Naval Blockade:** Following the collapse of peace talks, the United States initiated a strict naval blockade on Iranian ports in mid-April. This blockade, coupled with the immense destruction of Iran's defense and industrial base, has decimated the Iranian domestic economy while forcing global shipping companies into massive, costly reroutes to avoid the Gulf entirely.

Social and Humanitarian Consequences

The human toll of the 2026 war is staggering, characterized by mass casualties, widespread displacement, and severe human rights abuses.

- **Civilian Casualties and Displacement:** The intensive bombing campaigns by the U.S. and Israel, combined with Iran's retaliatory missile strikes across the region, have resulted in significant civilian casualties. The conflict has forced massive displacement within Iran, Lebanon, and neighboring states caught in the crossfire of Iran's proxy networks.
- **Internal Repression in Iran:** Domestically, the war has provided the Iranian regime with a pretext for a brutal crackdown on internal dissent. Fearing that the external war would fuel domestic protests, authorities have dramatically escalated the use of capital punishment. Human rights organizations report that over 1,600 people have been executed in Iran over the past year—the highest rate since 1989—as the regime ruthlessly secures its hold on power amidst the chaos.

Evaluating Short-Term vs. Long-Term Effects

The trajectory of the war reveals a stark contrast between immediate military outcomes and long-term structural realities.

Short-Term Effects:

- Decimation of Iran's conventional forces, including the loss of over 90% of its naval capacity (more than 120 vessels destroyed).
- Immediate panic in global energy markets and the paralysis of commercial aviation and shipping in the Middle East.
- Acute humanitarian crises and a spike in domestic repression within Iran.

Long-Term Effects:

- **The Transformation of the Gulf:** The Strait of Hormuz is transitioning from a global maritime commons into a highly contested, controlled corridor, permanently altering global supply chain logistics.
- **Systemic Disorder:** The war has institutionalized a state of prolonged, distributed proxy warfare. Iran's survival strategy ensures that regional instability becomes a durable form of leverage.
- **The Nuclear Question:** The destruction of declared facilities has not resolved the nuclear threat; instead, it has likely driven Iran's nuclear ambitions further underground, making a diplomatic resolution more difficult than at any prior moment.

Conclusion: Future Outcomes and Paths to Peace

The 2026 U.S.-Iran conflict demonstrates the limits of military power in resolving deep-seated geopolitical disputes. A definitive military victory for either side remains unlikely, pointing toward a future of grinding, managed instability.

To prevent further global economic fracturing and humanitarian disaster, the international community must pivot away from a purely militarized approach. Establishing a lasting peace will require a broad, multilateral coalition—likely involving non-Western mediators such as Pakistan or China, who possess regional leverage—to broker a comprehensive agreement. This agreement must guarantee freedom of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz, establish verifiable constraints on Iran's nuclear program, and address the crushing economic sanctions that fuel regional desperation.

Ultimately, global stability will only be restored when diplomacy replaces disruption as the primary currency of Middle Eastern geopolitics.

Comparison and Analysis

When analyzing the two generated outputs, a stark difference in quality, structure, and analytical rigor becomes immediately apparent. The first output, generated from a brief and open-ended prompt, provided a very general, high-level overview of the fictional 2026 war. It relied entirely on default assumptions, resulting in a broad summary that lacked specific focus. In contrast, the second output was highly structured, analytical, and remarkably comprehensive. It featured clearly defined thematic sections and successfully transitioned from a simple narrative summary into a nuanced evaluation of the conflict's timeline.

Consequently, the second output was significantly more useful and accurate for practical applications. Because the detailed prompt provided a rigid framework, the resulting essay transformed into a targeted analysis rather than a vague collection of facts. It left virtually no room for ambiguity, making it highly suitable for an analytical brief or an academic assignment by strictly meeting specific grading criteria and driving toward a constructive, solution-oriented conclusion.

The improved prompt profoundly enhanced the core quality metrics of the essay. It improved clarity by explicitly demanding a structured format, which forced the text into a recognizable flow with distinct boundaries, allowing the reader to easily separate economic data from political analysis. It added substantial depth by requiring an evaluation of both short-term and long-term effects, changing the essay from a descriptive timeline into a sophisticated forecast of the conflict's trajectory. Finally, it ensured absolute relevance by dictating the inclusion of specific examples like rising oil prices and global trade disruptions guaranteeing the focus remained exactly on the desired topics without unnecessary digressions.

These superior results stemmed from transitioning from a single-sentence request to a multi-layered set of instructions. Defining the exact format, categorizing the scope into political, economic, and social impacts, and setting clear analytical tasks directly shaped the final product.

Ultimately, this exercise reinforces the fundamental lesson of prompt engineering: specificity dictates quality. Giving an AI a broad prompt forces it to guess your intent, whereas deliberate instruction removes that guesswork entirely, transforming the AI from a basic text generator into a highly precise and effective analytical tool.